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Company:BlackRock

Job Profile:SDE

Offer Type: Internship

Internship Stipend:Rs 50,000 per month

CTC:18 LPA (Performance based PPO)

Location:Mumbai/Gurgaon

Process Date: 28/08/2025-29/08/2025

Placement Process:

There was an Online Assessment followed by 2 Technical Interview Rounds.

Since it was Pool Campus Placement various other colleges also participated in it.

1. **[Online Assessment Test]   (After PPT)**

The online assessment round was fully MCQ-based with a total duration of two hours. The test was divided into three main sections: Aptitude, Technical, and Flowchart-based Coding. Each section had 3–4 subsections with individual timers ranging between 10 to 20 minutes, which made time management a very crucial factor. Students with cgpa>7.5 were allowed, and only a smaller percentage were shortlisted based on sectional performance and overall accuracy.

The **Aptitude section** consisted of questions from quantitative aptitude, logical reasoning, and verbal ability. Topics like speed, time and distance, profit and loss, probability, puzzles, and data interpretation were commonly asked. The verbal subsection included paragraph-based comprehension questions that were strictly timed, requiring quick reading and precise answering. My approach here was to eliminate wrong options quickly and focus on accuracy instead of random guessing.

The **Technical section** tested core programming concepts, primarily object-oriented programming (OOPs) in Java, C++, and Python. Questions asked us to identify differences between abstraction and encapsulation, select the correct definition of method overloading versus overriding, or point out the role of garbage collection in Python versus destructors in C++. SQL-based MCQs included queries for finding the second highest salary, identifying invalid JOINs, and error-checking. There were also input-output questions where code snippets were given and we had to predict the exact output or the type of error (runtime or compile-time). I prepared for this by revising OOPs fundamentals and practicing SQL queries in advance, which helped me trace the logic accurately during the test.

The **flowchart-based coding section** was slightly different from standard coding rounds, as it involved tracing algorithms presented in flowchart form. Questions asked us to trace a given flowchart and select the correct output from the options. I managed this by simulating the flow on rough paper step by step, which reduced mistakes and saved time.

To prepare for this round, I practiced aptitude questions regularly on IndiaBix and GeeksforGeeks Aptitude. For technical sections, I revised OOPs concepts in depth and solved SQL MCQs from GeeksforGeeks SQL MCQs. I also focused on understanding common compile-time and runtime errors in different languages, as error-based MCQs were common. For flowcharts, I brushed up on the basics of loops, conditionals, and algorithm tracing.

On the day of the test, I made sure to keep rough paper ready for quick calculations and flowchart tracing. Since the subsections were auto-submitted after the timer,

I was careful not to spend too much time on any one question. Overall, the key points you need to learn is to manage time effectively, stay calm during timed reading comprehensions, and have strong fundamentals in OOPs and SQL.

2. **[Technical Interview Round 1]** [27 appeared (excluding 8 waiting not allowed)] .

The first interview round began with a polite greeting and a brief self-introduction, where I highlighted my academic background, project work, and any relevant experiences. The interviewer then asked me to explain my projects in detail, focusing on the technologies used, the challenges faced, and the outcomes. I was also asked about my work experience, hobbies, and the skills I had gained from practical exposure. From there, the discussion moved to technical fundamentals, where I was asked about the four pillars of Object-Oriented Programming and to name the programming languages I was most comfortable with.

The interviewer also touched on role-fit and motivation questions, such as why I wanted to join **BlackRock**. I answered honestly, focusing on my interest in working with a global firm known for innovation and technology in finance.

When asked about my knowledge of finance, I admitted that I did not have sufficient background but emphasized my willingness and eagerness to learn, which the interviewer seemed to appreciate. Toward the end, I was given the opportunity to ask a question, and I inquired about his routine and experience at BlackRock, which led to a more casual and insightful exchange.

Throughout the interview, I made sure to remain confident and articulate in my responses, even though I knew it was challenging to stay composed in such situations. The interviewer maintained a friendly and supportive approach, which made the conversation more comfortable. My key takeaway from this round was that confidence, clarity in explaining one's projects, and openness to learning new domains like finance are crucial.

Links:

https://www.geeksforgeeks.org/java/object-oriented-programming-oops-concept-in-java/

https://www.geeksforgeeks.org/aptitude/puzzles/

3. **[Technical Interview Round 2] (16 students appeared)**

The second interview round was more project-focused and technical in nature. The interviewer began by asking me to choose one project that I would like to deep dive into. Once I selected the project, she asked detailed questions about its architecture, schema design, and the reasoning behind my technical choices. A key discussion point was on database design, where she asked me to compare **SQL vs. NoSQL** and explain which one I preferred in different scenarios. I elaborated on aspects like structured vs. unstructured data, scalability, and consistency, while also discussing how collections, documents, and sub-collections work in NoSQL databases.

The interviewer then shifted the conversation toward financial awareness, asking how I keep myself updated with current financial situations. I responded by mentioning sources like financial news portals, online articles, and business publications, while also admitting I was still in the process of building deeper financial knowledge. Moving further, I was asked **data analysis-oriented questions** such as how I handled datasets in my projects, what tools I used, and importantly, whether I had deployed my work or kept it at an experimental stage. I clarified the scope of deployment in my projects and described my exposure to end-to-end development.

Overall, this round tested my ability to defend my project choices, my database knowledge, my awareness of financial trends, and my practical experience in implementation. The interviewer maintained an analytical approach, probing deeper into technical and real-world application aspects, which made it important to stay structured in my responses and connect technical knowledge with practical use cases.

https://www.geeksforgeeks.org/dbms/introduction-to-nosql/

https://www.geeksforgeeks.org/reactjs/react/

Prank Round

During the BlackRock process, after finishing my two technical rounds, our TPC told us about the prank round that had been taken earlier by our TPO head, Mr. Vinod Sikka. On the same day, I also had an EDS interview scheduled at their office, so I was really stressed trying to manage both. While waiting for the BlackRock result, the tension kept building, but finally, my name was announced for the SDE role. That moment was such a big relief and honestly one of the happiest feelings—I realized how important it is to stay calm under pressure and I felt super excited to join BlackRock.

[Total 10 selected students –> 7 for SDE+2 Aladdin data +1 Global Marketing]

Useful Tips:

Another important lesson is that **every interview is a learning opportunity**. For instance, my earlier experience with Baker Hughes interviews taught me a lot about technical execution, especially in-depth concepts like OAuth implementation, which I later applied successfully in my projects. These learnings accumulate over time, and no effort goes to waste.

Lastly, while preparation and hard work form the foundation, one must also acknowledge that luck plays a role—being at the right place at the right time matters. So, it is essential to keep doing good work, keep learning, and stay consistent, because opportunities will continue to come.